FOUND SOUND

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Demo Quick Sampler with a live recording. Students begin collecting sounds.	Slides 1–7: hook, what found sound is, from sound to song, a live demo, steps 1 and 2. Record a sound in front of the class and play it in Quick Sampler. Hand out the project sheet and the Sound log.	Slides 1–7	p. 12, p. 15, p. 16, p. 17, p. 19
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Edit and prep recordings. Begin building instruments in Quick Sampler.	Slides 8–10: the three Quick Sampler modes, a live demo of all three, go weird. Students trim and normalize, then start the Instrument builder.	Slides 8–10	p. 10, p. 13, p. 9
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, layer, and mix.	Slides 11–12: compose with your instruments, three layers. Hand out the Layer plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–12	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 13–14: the worked example on paper and the layer check. Then work time.	Slides 13–14	p. 14
CLASS 5		Full working day: compose, layer and mix. Ask each student to play you one instrument and say what sound it came from.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 15–17: mix and finalize, what to turn in, the rubric. Students self-score and post their three questions.	Slides 15–17	p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions. Reflection (page 21) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 20, p. 21

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

Students record before they edit. By the end of Class 1 every student has at least one clean recording on the Sound log (page 12), so Class 2 is spent building instruments, not hunting for sounds.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: which layer is this, and what sound did it come from? Instruments that never reach the Layer plan are my third struggle.

PREVIEW

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FOUND SOUND

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

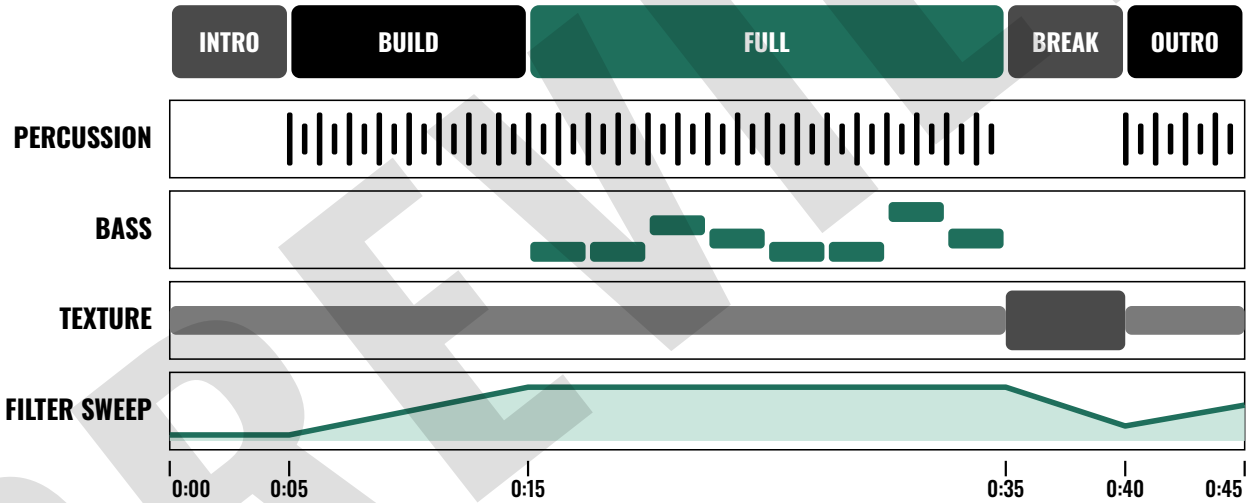
Teacher

An **invented piece, "Passing Period", described on paper**: no audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' pieces will differ.

1 · THE FIVE SOUNDS ·

SOUND	RECORDED WITH	QUICK SAMPLER	LAYER	WHAT IT DOES
Locker slam	phone, one take	Slice (5 slices)	Percussion	slices on five keys: boom, rattle, click
Pencil tap	station microphone	Classic, short	Percussion	pitched up, played as a tick
Door thud	phone	Classic, pitched down	Bass	played as a simple bassline
Vending-machine hum	phone, 20 seconds	Classic, loop on	Texture	held under everything, filter sweeps
Water-bottle crinkle	station microphone	One Shot	Texture	one press at the start of the Break

2 · THE PLAN: 45 SECONDS ·



Intro 0:00–0:05, Build 0:05–0:15, Full 0:15–0:35, Break 0:35–0:40, Outro 0:40–0:45. The plan is 45 seconds: inside my 30–60 second requirement.

3 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

96 beats per minute is 0.625 s a beat, so a bar of 4/4 is 2.5 s. Sections: 2 + 4 + 8 + 2 + 2 = 18 bars, and 18 × 2.5 s = 45 s. From 0:15 to 0:35 all three layers play at once. Five sounds are recorded and all five are used.

4 · WHY IT WORKS

Each layer has a job: the hum is the room, the taps and slams are the beat, the thud is the floor. The filter sweep means the texture changes without adding anything. A listener should struggle to guess the sources.

5 · THREE PADLET QUESTIONS (INVENTED) ·

1. Which sound did you guess first, and which one fooled you? 2. If you took one layer out, which one would you miss most? 3. Where does the track change the most, and how did I do it?

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FOUND SOUND

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Record or source at least 5 original audio samples
- ☐ Edit, trim, and normalize sounds in Logic Pro
- ☐ Import sounds into Quick Sampler to create playable instruments
- ☐ Design at least 3 distinct sound layers (e.g., percussion, bass, texture)
- ☐ Apply effects and automation for dynamics and interest
- ☐ Length: 30–60 seconds

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Collect sounds** — Record at least 5 sounds using your phone or the microphone at your station (Sound log: page 12)
2. **Edit and prep** — Trim, normalize, and clean up your recordings in Logic (Logic quick reference: page 9)
3. **Build instruments** — Import sounds into Quick Sampler and experiment with playback modes (Quick Sampler modes: page 10; Instrument builder: page 13)
4. **Compose** — Use your custom instruments to build a short piece with at least 3 layers (Layer plan: page 14)
5. **Mix** — Apply EQ, effects, and automation. Balance levels and add polish.
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your track and prepare your presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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FOUND SOUND

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Found Sound | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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